

Activity 11 Instruction Manual

Activity 11 | Topic 02 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

Executing a project generates a flood of raw data. You will use GenAI to turn that data into information, and information into a report a sponsor will actually read - while learning the distinction that PMBOK draws between the three.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A project status report generated from raw work performance data.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. In your group, write out ten lines of raw work performance data for a project in progress - for example '14 defects open', 'actual cost to date \$62,000', '3 change requests raised'.
2. Confirm the distinction before you prompt: Data is the raw observation; Information compares two or more data points to make it meaningful; a Report is the representation intended to raise action or awareness.
3. Prompt GenAI: 'Here is raw work performance data from my project [paste]. Convert it into work performance information by comparing against the plan, then produce a one-page status report for an executive sponsor.'
4. Check what it inferred. It will assume a baseline you never gave it - identify every comparison it invented and supply the real planned figure.
5. Prompt it to sharpen the report: 'Rewrite this so the first three lines tell the sponsor whether the project is on track, what the single biggest problem is, and what decision I need from them.'
6. Add a version control block - version number, date/time stamp and author - as required for project document control.
7. Use the Persona pattern to test it: 'Act as a sceptical project sponsor. What would you challenge in this report?' Address the challenges it raises.
8. Share your report and state which figure GenAI fabricated before you corrected it.

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- Your report distinguishes data from information, every comparison uses a real baseline figure, and it opens with status, biggest problem and the decision required.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.